

In Example 1, the squares ($\square$) identify the pivot positions.

Example 2: Row reduce the matrix A below to echelon form, and locate the pivot columns of A .

$$A = \begin{bmatrix} 0 & -3 & -6 & 4 & 9 \\ -1 & -2 & -1 & 3 & 1 \\ -2 & -3 & 0 & 3 & -1 \\ 1 & 4 & 5 & -9 & -7 \end{bmatrix}$$

Solution: **Step 1:** Interchange Row 4 and Row 1

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 4 & 5 & -9 & -7 \\ -1 & -2 & -1 & 3 & 1 \\ -2 & -3 & 0 & 3 & -1 \\ 0 & -3 & -6 & 4 & 9 \end{bmatrix}$$

Step 2:

New row 2 = Row 1 + Old row 2

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 4 & 5 & -9 & -7 \\ 0 & 2 & 4 & -6 & -6 \\ -2 & -3 & 0 & 3 & -1 \\ 0 & -3 & -6 & 4 & 9 \end{bmatrix}$$

Step 3:

New Row 3 = Row 1 $\times 2$ + Old row 3

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 4 & 5 & -9 & -7 \\ 0 & 2 & 4 & -6 & -6 \\ 0 & 5 & 10 & -15 & -15 \\ 0 & -3 & -6 & 4 & 9 \end{bmatrix}$$

Step 4:

New Row 3 = Row 3 - $\frac{5}{2} \times$ Row 2

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 4 & 5 & -9 & -7 \\ 0 & 2 & 4 & -6 & -6 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & -3 & -6 & 4 & 9 \end{bmatrix}$$

Step 5:

New Row 4 = Old Row 4 - Row 2 $\times \frac{3}{2}$

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 4 & 5 & -9 & -7 \\ 0 & 2 & 4 & -6 & -6 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 13 & 18 \end{bmatrix}$$

Step 6:

Interchange Row 3 and Row 4

$$\begin{bmatrix} 1 & 4 & 5 & -9 & -7 \\ 0 & 2 & 4 & -6 & -6 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 13 & 18 \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 & 0 \end{bmatrix}$$